

KAI MORI

01:00

THE INFECTION OF SIGHT

— 視覚の感染 —

TOKYO. 07:42 A.M.

ANOTHER
MORNING.

ANOTHER
CAR.

THE NEXT STOP IS
SHINJUKU.
SHINJUKU.

DOORS WILL
CLOSE ON
THE LEFT.

KAI MORI. 17.
THE READER
OF TRUTH.

MY BODY IS
STILL.

MY EYES
ARE NOT.

I CATALOGUE.

FACES.
VOICES.

MICRO-EXPRESSIONS.
BREATH RATES.

LIES.

NOT BY CHOICE.

IT'S
CONSTANT.

IT'S
EXHAUSTING.

BUT IT'S
THE ONLY WAY
TO SURVIVE.

TODAY,

SOMETHING IS
ALREADY WRONG.

THE TRAIN
PULLS AWAY.

ANOTHER DAY
BEGINS.

A THIN,
COLD BLUE LINE,

BARELY
THERE.

I SEE IT.

NO ONE
ELSE DOES.

KAI MORI

THE READER OF TRUTH

CHAPTER 1: THE LINE NO ONE SEES

TO BE CONTINUED.

SUBJECTIVE POV: KAI MORI

CONDITION: READER OF TRUTH

NOTE: VISUAL OVERLAY, NOT REAL.

MARRIED.
HAVING AN AFFAIR.
3 YEARS.

OWES ¥2,850,000.
CAN'T TELL HIS
PARENTS.

HATES HIS JOB.
DREAMED OF
QUITTING.
FORGOT HOW.

SMILES IN PUBLIC.
SELF-HARM
AT NIGHT.

MOTHER
IN HOSPICE.
VISITS WHEN
SHE'S ASLEEP.

GAMBLING DEBT.
SOLD HIS BIKE.

FEELS INVISIBLE.
NOTICED BY NO ONE.
NOT EVEN HER.

TOO MANY.
NONE OF THEM CHOSEN.
NONE OF THEM AVOIDABLE.
THIS ISN'T A GIFT.
IT'S A CONDITION.

GROUNDING PROTOCOL:
PRIME NUMBERS.
THE ONLY PATTERN
THAT HOLDS.
THE ONLY THING
THAT SLOWS
THE FLOOD.

2.
TWO.
BREATHE IN.



3.
THREE.
HOLD.



5.
FIVE.
FOCUS.



7.
SEVEN.
STAY.



11.
ELEVEN.
ANCHOR.



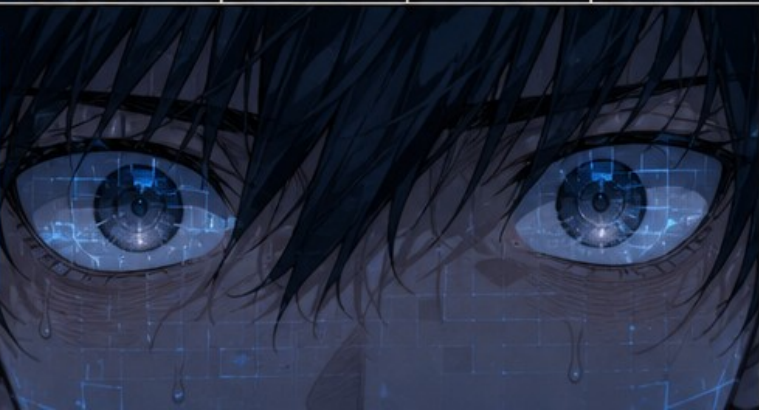
13.
THIRTEEN.
ENDURE.



THE GRID.
THE FRAGMENTS.
THE TRUTHS.
ALL OF THEM
PRESSING IN.

ALL OF THEM
REAL.

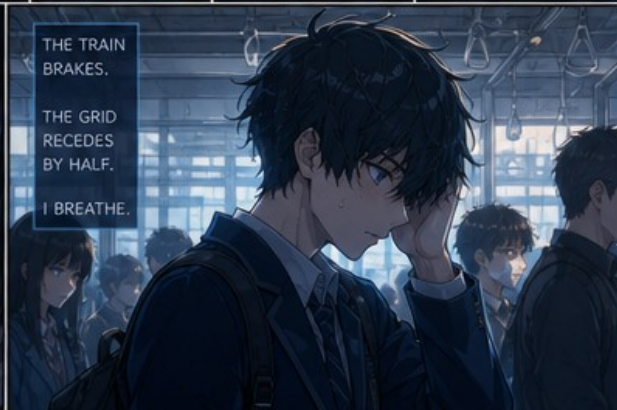
NONE OF THEM
MINE TO BEAR.



THE TRAIN
BRAKES.

THE GRID
RECEDES
BY HALF.

I BREATHE.



KUROHANE PREFECTURAL HIGH SCHOOL
— MORNING

自主 誠実
自造 誠実

黒羽県立高等学校

Your attendance is flawless, Mori, but your focus is slipping. The Board expects excellence. We don't want you to become a distraction.

VICE PRINCIPAL
ASHIDA

KAI MORI
— 2ND YEAR

HEY, KAI!!

You're late!
Hurry in.

SEIRYOU ACADEMY
7:45 AM

KAI MORI – 17
The Reader of Truth

ASHIDA
Vice Principal

MORI-KUN.

THANK YOU FOR
BRINGING THE
LAB EQUIPMENT
REPORT.

YOUR
ATTENTION TO
DETAIL UPHOLDS
OUR STANDARDS.

清陵学園

PRESENT TRUTH: ASHIDA

SURFACE:
COMPOSED. PROFESSIONAL.
DEDICATED TO INSTITUTION.

CORE FEAR:
INSTITUTIONAL COLLAPSE.
THE MOMENT THE NUMBERS
CATCH UP TO REALITY.

FINANCIAL REALITY:
¥ 3,208,742,000
UNREPORTED DEFICIT

DAILY CALCULATION LOOP:
CUT PROGRAMS.
DELAY PAYMENTS.
RENEGOTIATE TERMS.
MAINTAIN CONFIDENCE.
PREVENT PANIC.

HIDDEN LABOR:
WORKING 18-HOUR DAYS.
PERSONALLY COVERING
SHORTFALLS.
BURNOUT MASKED
BY DISCIPLINE.

SINGLE OBSESSION:
KEEP THE STRUCTURE
STANDING.
AT ANY COST.

INFORMATION
ACQUIRED.

CATALOGUED.
INDEXED.
IRREVOCABLE.

FILED AWAY.
NO REACTION
REQUIRED.
CONTINUE.
OBSERVE.
ENDURE.
MOVE FORWARD.

5-YEAR PROJECTED SHORTFALL



ANOTHER TRUTH.
ANOTHER WEIGHT.

THE CATALOGUE
GROWS.
IT ALWAYS GROWS.

THE WORLD THINKS
HE
PERFORMED A SMALL
ACT OF KINDNESS.

HE DOES NOT KNOW
THAT HIS ENTIRE
FEAR WAS JUST READ
AND REMAINED
UNFLINCHED.

KAI MORI - 17
THE READER OF TRUTH

THE READER
IS ALWAYS
TIRED.

FIRST
PERIOD
IS NOISY.

THIS IS
QUIETER.

HERE,
THERE'S
NO ONE TO
READ.

I CAN
BREATHE.

NO ONE
HERE.

NO TRUTHS
TO READ.

JUST
TIE,
FLUORESCENT
LIGHT, AND
TIME.

UNTIL
THE BELL.

NOTHING
SPECIAL.

CHEAP
COVER.

100 YEN
NOTEBOOK.

ORDINARY.

BLANK
PAGES.

JUST
MATH.

KLIK.

CLEAR
MIND.

CLEAN
WORK.

ONE STEP
AT A TIME.

$$(x+2)^2 = x^2 + 4x + 4$$

SOLVABLE.

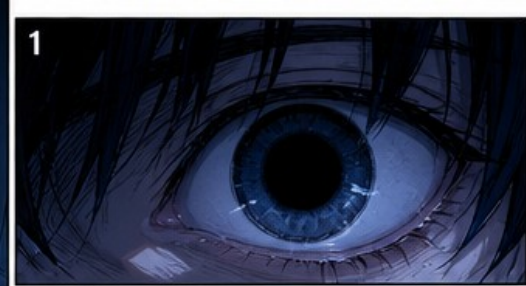
NORMAL.

KAI MORI — 17

THE READER OF TRUTH

BATHROOM STALL 3B
2:17 PM

VISUAL DECOMPRESSION:
THE MOMENT OF SEIZURE
STRETCHED ACROSS MANY
PANELS.



EYES OPEN.
MIND GONE.

A PASSENGER
INSIDE HIS
OWN HAND.

NO ONE KNOWS.
NO ONE WILL EVER
KNOW.

EXCEPT KAI.

TRUTH ISN'T
LOOKED AT.
IT LOOKS
BACK.
K.M.

KAI MORI — 17
The Reader of Truth.

I DON'T REMEMBER
WRITING ANY
OF THIS.

HFF--

NOT ENTIRELY
MY OWN
TO ME.

PAGES. FILLED.
EDGE TO EDGE.
IN A HAND
I DIDN'T CHOOSE.

Student council +
general fund 6,312,000
FY 2,940,000
(April 1 - March 31)
- 3,372,000

Unexplained deficit
(as per board review)
- 3,372,000

- Records falsified
- Invoices fabricated
- Payments rerouted
- Oversight bypassed

~ systematically
over 11 months
(May - March)

Total: ¥3,372,000

NOT NONSENSE. AN ACCOUNT. DETAILED. SPECIFIC.

Hideo Naka

Student council
treasurer
direct access
to accounts

Method:

1. Create false vendor
(H.N. Consulting)
2. Submit inflated
receipts
3. Route funds via
school account
4. Cover with event
expenditures
(culture festival, etc.)
5. Alter ledger entries

The board's
deficit is not
mismanagement.
It is buried.

Beneath the council.
Beneath Naka.
Beneath lies.

The truth is
in plain sight.
For those who
can read.

CONFUSION.

...?

REALISATION.

CONNECTION.

UNDERSTANDING.

CLOSE IT.
AND CARRY IT.
THE TRUTH
DOESN'T NEED
A WITNESS.

ハナシ...

JUST A READER.

THREE HUNDRED STUDENTS.
THREE HUNDRED LIES.

I ONLY READ ONE.

TRUTH ISN'T GIVEN. IT'S READ.

HIDEO NAKA. 18.
STUDENT COUNCIL TREASURER.

[PRESENT TRUTH: HIDEO NAKA]

[FALSIFIED RECORD #1]
CLUB FUND ALLOCATION
— ALTERED

[FALSIFIED RECORD #2]
SCHOLARSHIP DISTRIBUTION
— MANIPULATED

[FALSIFIED RECORD #3]
BUILDING MAINTENANCE BID
— RIGGED

[EMOTION: ANXIETY]
87.6%

[EMOTION: GUILT]
91.3%

[CORE FEAR:
EXPOSURE]
100.0%

I DON'T WANT TO.

BUT I DO.

HIDEO NAKA

- TREASURER
- WATCH THE RECORDS.

NOTES

- ☐ FALSIFIED RECORDS
- ☐ FUNDS MISAPPROPRIATED
- ☐ HIDING DEBT
- ☐ AFRAID OF DISCOVERY

CONCLUSION:
HE WILL DO ANYTHING
TO STAY HIDDEN.

HE LAUGHS.

HE HAS NO IDEA.

THE NOTEBOOK
WAS RIGHT.

EVERY LINE.
EVERY DETAIL.
EVERY LIE.

APPETITE DIES
WHEN TRUTH
BECOMES
CERTAINTY.

KAI MORI
THE READER OF TRUTH

EPISODE: LUNCHTIME
LOCATION: SEIKYOU HIGH SCHOOL CAFETERIA
TIME: 12:37 PM



KAI MORI — 17
THE READER OF TRUTH

He writes.
The truth writes back.
He cannot refuse.
He can only record.

I LEFT
MY TRAY
BEHIND.

AT FIRST,
IT WAS
COLD.
CONFIRMATION.

THEN IT
STOPPED
BEING
COLD.
IT
BECAME
SOMETHING
SHARPER.

IT USED
ME LIKE
A PRINTER.

NOT ANGER
THAT THE TRUTH
IS REAL.

ANGER AT THE
MECHANISM.

AT BEING
MADE TO
WRITE IT.

AT MY OWN HAND
BEING USED
WITHOUT MY
CONSENT.

AT THE SPECIFIC VIOLATION OF DISCOVERING THAT SOMETHING
CAN REACH INSIDE ME AND USE MY BODY AS AN INSTRUMENT.

DOWN THERE,
LIFE CONTINUES.
NAKA'S TABLE.
ORDINARY VOICES.
ORDINARY DAYS.

THEY DON'T KNOW
WHAT'S WRITTEN.

THEY DON'T KNOW
WHAT'S COMING.

I HOLD
THE SHAPE
OF A COMING
CATASTROPHE.

AND I HATE
THE THING
THAT FORCED
ME TO WRITE
IT DOWN.

AFTER CLASSES.
THE LIBRARY.

THE LIBRARY,
MOSTLY EMPTY.
THE HUM OF OLD
MACHINES.

A LIBRARIAN
SHELVING BOOKS
IN THE FAR STACKS,
PAYING NO
ATTENTION.



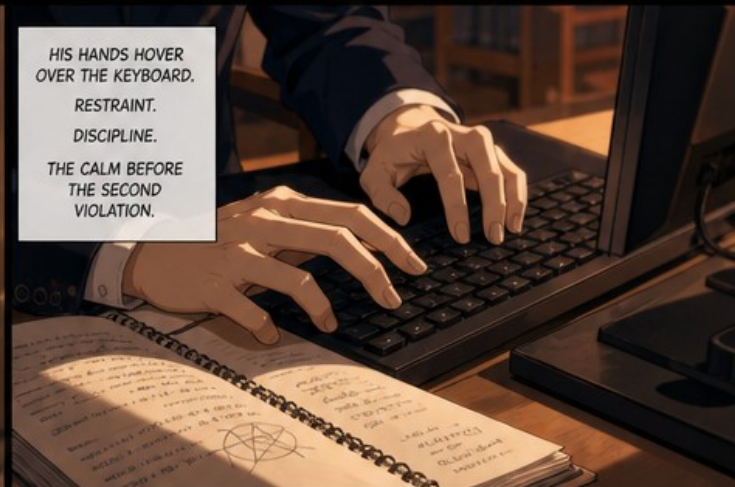
KAI MORI. 17.
THE READER OF TRUTH.

HE INTENDS TO
DO THE RESPONSIBLE
THING:
PHOTOGRAPH NOTHING.
TRANSCRIBE NOTHING.
SIMPLY DELETE
THE KNOWLEDGE
FROM ACTIVE
CONSIDERATION.

DECIDE LATER,
CALMLY, WHAT—
IF ANYTHING—
SHOULD BE DONE
WITH IT.

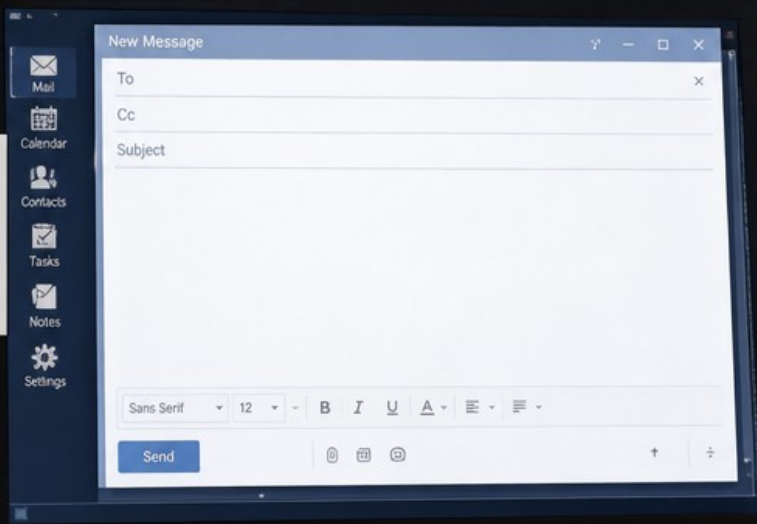


HIS HANDS HOVER
OVER THE KEYBOARD.
RESTRAINT.
DISCIPLINE.
THE CALM BEFORE
THE SECOND
VIOLATION.



HE OPENS
A BLANK
EMAIL WINDOW.

INTENDING
ONLY TO DRAFT
A PRIVATE NOTE
TO HIMSELF.
A PLACE TO
SET THE WEIGHT
DOWN SAFELY.



THE LIBRARY
IS QUIET.
GOLDEN WITH
LATE-AFTERNOON
LIGHT.

THE BLANK
EMAIL WINDOW
IS THE SCENE'S
QUIET, FATEFUL
OBJECT.



TO BE CONTINUED.

VISUAL DECOMPRESSION
EPISODE 02: SECOND FUGUE
LIBRARY TERMINAL
14:37:12

1

HIS EYES LOSE FOCUS
EXACTLY AS THEY DID
IN THE BATHROOM.
PUPILS DILATE.

KAI MORI — 17
THE READER OF TRUTH

2

HIS HANDS BEGIN TO MOVE
AT A SPEED NO ORDINARY
TYPING REACHES.
FINGERS BLUR ACROSS
THE KEYS.

3

THE EMAIL WINDOW FILLS
RAPIDLY WITH TEXT AND
ATTACHED SCANNED IMAGES
OF THE NOTEBOOK'S PAGES.
THE CURSOR FLIES THROUGH
ADDRESS FIELDS —
SCHOOL.BOARD,
PTA.COMMITTEE,
AND FINALLY A LOCAL
NEWS OUTLET'S
TIP-LINE ADDRESS.

To: school.board@seihou-edu.jp
Cc: pta.committee@seihou-edu.jp
Bcc: tipline@eastviewherald.tl
Subject: Formal Complaint: Misconduct and Cover-Up at Seihou High

Send

To Whom It May Concern,
I am writing to formally report serious misconduct and a cover-up involv
Seihou High School. The evidence attached includes scanned pages fr
an unredacted notebook documenting the actions of faculty members
and administrators. The contents speak for themselves.
This is not an accusation made lightly. It is a record.
Kai Mori

11 Attachments (11.2 MB)



+3 more

4

KAI'S SLACK FACE,
MOUTH OPEN.
UTTERLY ABSENT
FROM HIS OWN
ACTIONS.

HIS BODY COMPLETES
A TASK HIS MIND
NEVER AUTHORISED.

5

THE LIBRARIAN
IN THE BACKGROUND,
OBLIVIOUS, STILL
SHELVING BOOKS.

THE ORDINARY
STILLNESS OF
THE LIBRARY
COMPLETELY
UNDISTURBED BY
THE VIOLENCE
HAPPENING SILENTLY
AT THE TERMINAL.

THE LIBRARY TERMINAL.
CONTINUOUS.

KAI MORI - 17
THE READER OF TRUTH



I am a
passenger
in my own
body.

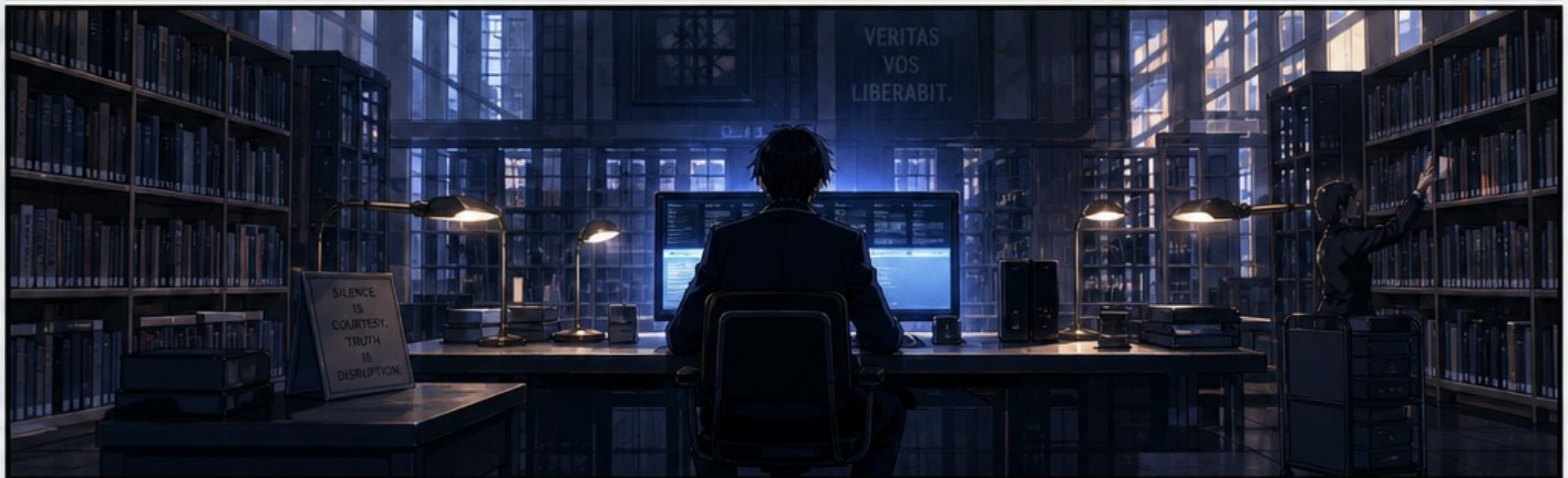


It cannot
be undone.



The truth
wants out.

It will use
me to get there.



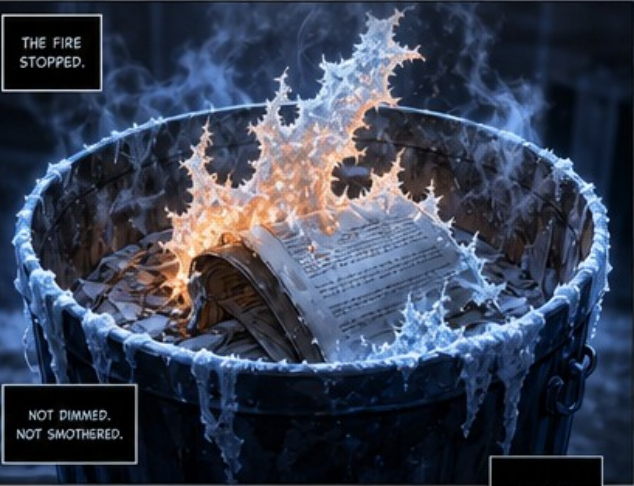
With or
without my
consent.

KAI MORI'S BEDROOM.
11:47 PM.



KAI MORI

CHAPTER 01: THE VISITOR.



THE FIRE
STOPPED.

NOT DIMMED.
NOT SMOTHERED.

FROZEN.



AND THE ROOM—
IT GOT COLD.

WRONG-COLD.



W-WHAT THE—



SCRAPE



HELLO,
KAI MORI.

MISSED
ME?

VAEL
AGE: UNKNOWN
NATURE: UNCATEGORIZED

W-WHO ARE
YOU?!



TO BE CONTINUED